



The QA Mythbuster Series: Episode 2

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 **TL;DR**

Here are **5 more myths** that separate beginners from professionals

 **The Advanced Myths**

Myth #6: "We can test quality into a product."

 **The Lie:** "If QA tests harder, the product will be high quality."

✅ **The Truth:** Quality must be **built in**, not tested in. If the code is badly designed, no amount of testing will fix it. I can find 100 bugs, but if the architecture is flawed, I'm just putting bandages on a broken leg. Quality is a **team responsibility** from Day 1, not something QA adds at the end.

Myth #7: "Testing starts after development is done."

❌ **The Lie:** "Developers code, then testers test."

✅ **The Truth:** This is the **Waterfall mindset**, and it's expensive. In Agile (and with **Shift Left**), testing starts from Day 1. I review requirements, participate in design discussions, and challenge assumptions before a single line of code is written. Waiting until the end means fixing bugs costs 10x more.

Myth #8: "A bug-free product means the testing was perfect."

❌ **The Lie:** "Zero bugs in production = QA did a flawless job."

✅ **The Truth:** Sometimes it means we got lucky. Or it means the users aren't using the edge cases yet. Or the product is so simple there wasn't much to break. Great QA isn't measured by zero bugs; it's measured by **finding the critical bugs before they reach production**. Perfection is impossible. Risk management is the goal.

Myth #9: "QA doesn't need technical skills."

❌ **The Lie:** "You just need to know how to click buttons and write reports."

✅ **The Truth:** Modern QA requires **SQL** (to verify database changes), **API testing** (Postman), **log analysis** (reading stack traces), understanding **HTTP status codes**, basic scripting, and tools like Jira/Git. The "non-technical tester" role is disappearing. Today's QA is a **technical investigator**, not just a button-clicker.

Myth #10: "If the developer says it works, it works."

❌ **The Lie:** "Developers test their own code, so QA is redundant."

✅ **The Truth:** Developers test the **happy path** (what they built). QA tests the **chaos path** (what breaks). A developer confirms "Login works." A tester asks:

- "What if I paste a 10,000-character password?"
- "What if I login on two devices at once?"
- "What if the session expires mid-click?"

Different mindset. Different bugs. That's why both roles exist.

💡 **Real World Example: Myth #6 - "We Can Test Quality Into a Product"**

Scenario: A banking app allows users to transfer money.

The Problem:

The developer writes the transfer logic but forgets to add a **transaction rollback** in case of failure.

Result: If the system crashes mid-transfer, money is deducted from Account A but never arrives in Account B.

What QA Can Do:

I test this and find the bug. I file a report: "Critical Bug: Money lost during transfer crash."

The developer fixes it by adding rollback logic.

What QA Cannot Do:

I cannot go back in time and tell the developer to use a **Database Transaction Pattern** from Day 1.

I cannot rewrite the architecture to make the system inherently safe.

The Truth:

Quality is **built** by good design decisions (using transactions, writing unit tests, doing code reviews).

Testing can only **reveal** the lack of quality. I can't "test" the product into being well-designed.
